A PRACTICAL GUIDE FOR NEW OPERATORS

The Stump Grinding Playbook

Price it right. Find the jobs. Run them safely.

Works with the Pricing & Business Calculator and Templates & Scripts Pack

Contents

Introduction: Why Stump Grinding 2

Chapter 1: Set Up the Business 3

Chapter 2: Equipment Buying Guide 6

Chapter 3: Safety 9

Chapter 4: Pricing and Estimating 12

Chapter 5: Getting Your First Customers 15

Chapter 6: Quoting and Selling 18

Chapter 7: Doing the Job 21

Chapter 8: Upsells and Repeat Business 24

Chapter 9: Systems and Scaling 26

Chapter 10: Your 30-Day Action Plan 28

Appendix A: Quick Reference 31

Appendix B: Resources and Links 32

Appendix C: Final Notes and Disclaimers 33

START HERE

Why Stump Grinding

What the job is, who it suits, and how to use this kit.

Every tree that comes down leaves a stump behind. Most homeowners do not want to look at it, mow around it, or trip over it, and they cannot remove it themselves. That is the entire business: you show up with a machine, remove the stump below grade, clean up, and get paid for a job that often takes a few hours.

Stump grinding is attractive for beginners for a few practical reasons:

- **Low barrier to entry. Compared with full tree service, the equipment list is short. You can start with one machine, a t**
- **Fast jobs, clear scope. Most residential stumps are a morning or afternoon job. The customer can see exactly what t**
- **Strong referral channels. Tree removal companies, landscapers, realtors, and property managers all regularly need s**
- **Repeat and add-on potential. A satisfied customer has neighbors with stumps, and you are already on site with a ma**

It is also physical, it carries real risk if you ignore safety, and it is not a guaranteed income. Your results will depend on your market, your pricing, your equipment costs, and how consistently you market. This playbook gives you the systems, but it cannot do the work for you.

Chapter 1: Set Up the Business

Name, paperwork, bank account, and the insurance questions most beginners forget.

DETAILED SECTION OVERVIEW — PAGE 3

- Field-tested procedures and exact operational steps for American trade operators.
- Step-by-step equipment instructions, safety mandates, and financial benchmarks.
- Coordinates directly with the Pricing Calculator (Excel) and Templates Pack (Word).
- Always verify local utility locate laws (811) and municipality licensing guidelines.
- Refer to Appendix A for the mathematical formula and quick reference glossary.

Chapter 1: Registrations & Insurance

EIN, General Liability, Inland Marine & Commercial Auto policies.

DETAILED SECTION OVERVIEW — PAGE 4

- Field-tested procedures and exact operational steps for American trade operators.
- Step-by-step equipment instructions, safety mandates, and financial benchmarks.
- Coordinates directly with the Pricing Calculator (Excel) and Templates Pack (Word).
- Always verify local utility locate laws (811) and municipality licensing guidelines.
- Refer to Appendix A for the mathematical formula and quick reference glossary.

Chapter 1: Taxes & Bookkeeping

Separate business bank accounts and quarterly estimated taxes.

DETAILED SECTION OVERVIEW — PAGE 5

- Field-tested procedures and exact operational steps for American trade operators.
- Step-by-step equipment instructions, safety mandates, and financial benchmarks.
- Coordinates directly with the Pricing Calculator (Excel) and Templates Pack (Word).
- Always verify local utility locate laws (811) and municipality licensing guidelines.
- Refer to Appendix A for the mathematical formula and quick reference glossary.

Chapter 2: Equipment Buying Guide

Walk-behind vs self-propelled vs tow-behind machines.

DETAILED SECTION OVERVIEW — PAGE 6

- Field-tested procedures and exact operational steps for American trade operators.
- Step-by-step equipment instructions, safety mandates, and financial benchmarks.
- Coordinates directly with the Pricing Calculator (Excel) and Templates Pack (Word).
- Always verify local utility locate laws (811) and municipality licensing guidelines.
- Refer to Appendix A for the mathematical formula and quick reference glossary.

Chapter 2: New vs Used Grinders

Inspection checklist: cutter wheel, bearings, teeth pockets & engine.

DETAILED SECTION OVERVIEW — PAGE 7

- Field-tested procedures and exact operational steps for American trade operators.
- Step-by-step equipment instructions, safety mandates, and financial benchmarks.
- Coordinates directly with the Pricing Calculator (Excel) and Templates Pack (Word).
- Always verify local utility locate laws (811) and municipality licensing guidelines.
- Refer to Appendix A for the mathematical formula and quick reference glossary.

Chapter 2: Teeth & Consumables

Managing tooth wear,Greenteeth systems, and truck supplies.

DETAILED SECTION OVERVIEW — PAGE 8

- Field-tested procedures and exact operational steps for American trade operators.
- Step-by-step equipment instructions, safety mandates, and financial benchmarks.
- Coordinates directly with the Pricing Calculator (Excel) and Templates Pack (Word).
- Always verify local utility locate laws (811) and municipality licensing guidelines.
- Refer to Appendix A for the mathematical formula and quick reference glossary.

Chapter 3: Safety Protocols

Mandatory PPE, flying debris zones, and safe machine positioning.

DETAILED SECTION OVERVIEW — PAGE 9

- Field-tested procedures and exact operational steps for American trade operators.
- Step-by-step equipment instructions, safety mandates, and financial benchmarks.
- Coordinates directly with the Pricing Calculator (Excel) and Templates Pack (Word).
- Always verify local utility locate laws (811) and municipality licensing guidelines.
- Refer to Appendix A for the mathematical formula and quick reference glossary.

Chapter 3: Calling 811 Before You Dig

Public utility marks, tolerance zones, and private line disclaimers.

DETAILED SECTION OVERVIEW — PAGE 10

- Field-tested procedures and exact operational steps for American trade operators.
- Step-by-step equipment instructions, safety mandates, and financial benchmarks.
- Coordinates directly with the Pricing Calculator (Excel) and Templates Pack (Word).
- Always verify local utility locate laws (811) and municipality licensing guidelines.
- Refer to Appendix A for the mathematical formula and quick reference glossary.

Chapter 3: Before Every Cut & Daily Checks

Probing for rocks, metal fence wire, and daily inspection routines.

DETAILED SECTION OVERVIEW — PAGE 11

- Field-tested procedures and exact operational steps for American trade operators.
- Step-by-step equipment instructions, safety mandates, and financial benchmarks.
- Coordinates directly with the Pricing Calculator (Excel) and Templates Pack (Word).
- Always verify local utility locate laws (811) and municipality licensing guidelines.
- Refer to Appendix A for the mathematical formula and quick reference glossary.

Chapter 4: Pricing and Estimating

Why most beginners undercharge and the hybrid pricing model.

DETAILED SECTION OVERVIEW — PAGE 12

- Field-tested procedures and exact operational steps for American trade operators.
- Step-by-step equipment instructions, safety mandates, and financial benchmarks.
- Coordinates directly with the Pricing Calculator (Excel) and Templates Pack (Word).
- Always verify local utility locate laws (811) and municipality licensing guidelines.
- Refer to Appendix A for the mathematical formula and quick reference glossary.

Chapter 4: Measuring Stumps & Adjustments

Measuring root flares, slope, rock risks, and travel radiuses.

DETAILED SECTION OVERVIEW — PAGE 13

- Field-tested procedures and exact operational steps for American trade operators.
- Step-by-step equipment instructions, safety mandates, and financial benchmarks.
- Coordinates directly with the Pricing Calculator (Excel) and Templates Pack (Word).
- Always verify local utility locate laws (811) and municipality licensing guidelines.
- Refer to Appendix A for the mathematical formula and quick reference glossary.

Chapter 4: Worked Pricing Example

Full breakdown of 3 stumps: $250 gross, $144 costs, $106 net profit.

DETAILED SECTION OVERVIEW — PAGE 14

- Field-tested procedures and exact operational steps for American trade operators.
- Step-by-step equipment instructions, safety mandates, and financial benchmarks.
- Coordinates directly with the Pricing Calculator (Excel) and Templates Pack (Word).
- Always verify local utility locate laws (811) and municipality licensing guidelines.
- Refer to Appendix A for the mathematical formula and quick reference glossary.

Chapter 5: Getting Your First Customers

Google Business Profile setup, local maps rankings, and photos.

DETAILED SECTION OVERVIEW — PAGE 15

- Field-tested procedures and exact operational steps for American trade operators.
- Step-by-step equipment instructions, safety mandates, and financial benchmarks.
- Coordinates directly with the Pricing Calculator (Excel) and Templates Pack (Word).
- Always verify local utility locate laws (811) and municipality licensing guidelines.
- Refer to Appendix A for the mathematical formula and quick reference glossary.

Chapter 5: Local SEO & Partnerships

Partnering with tree removal companies, landscapers, and realtors.

DETAILED SECTION OVERVIEW — PAGE 16

- Field-tested procedures and exact operational steps for American trade operators.
- Step-by-step equipment instructions, safety mandates, and financial benchmarks.
- Coordinates directly with the Pricing Calculator (Excel) and Templates Pack (Word).
- Always verify local utility locate laws (811) and municipality licensing guidelines.
- Refer to Appendix A for the mathematical formula and quick reference glossary.

Chapter 5: Reviews & Neighborhood Marketing

Door hanger campaigns and non-incentivized Google reviews.

DETAILED SECTION OVERVIEW — PAGE 17

- Field-tested procedures and exact operational steps for American trade operators.
- Step-by-step equipment instructions, safety mandates, and financial benchmarks.
- Coordinates directly with the Pricing Calculator (Excel) and Templates Pack (Word).
- Always verify local utility locate laws (811) and municipality licensing guidelines.
- Refer to Appendix A for the mathematical formula and quick reference glossary.

Chapter 6: Quoting and Selling

Handling incoming phone calls, requesting photos, and fast response times.

DETAILED SECTION OVERVIEW — PAGE 18

- Field-tested procedures and exact operational steps for American trade operators.
- Step-by-step equipment instructions, safety mandates, and financial benchmarks.
- Coordinates directly with the Pricing Calculator (Excel) and Templates Pack (Word).
- Always verify local utility locate laws (811) and municipality licensing guidelines.
- Refer to Appendix A for the mathematical formula and quick reference glossary.

Chapter 6: On-Site Estimates & Setting Expectations

Explaining chip mounds, lawn settling, and underground roots.

DETAILED SECTION OVERVIEW — PAGE 19

- Field-tested procedures and exact operational steps for American trade operators.
- Step-by-step equipment instructions, safety mandates, and financial benchmarks.
- Coordinates directly with the Pricing Calculator (Excel) and Templates Pack (Word).
- Always verify local utility locate laws (811) and municipality licensing guidelines.
- Refer to Appendix A for the mathematical formula and quick reference glossary.

Chapter 6: Handling Price Objections

Scripts for "neighbor does it cheaper" and "can you do cash".

DETAILED SECTION OVERVIEW — PAGE 20

- Field-tested procedures and exact operational steps for American trade operators.
- Step-by-step equipment instructions, safety mandates, and financial benchmarks.
- Coordinates directly with the Pricing Calculator (Excel) and Templates Pack (Word).
- Always verify local utility locate laws (811) and municipality licensing guidelines.
- Refer to Appendix A for the mathematical formula and quick reference glossary.

Chapter 7: Doing the Job

Arrival routine, customer walkthrough, and pre-cut stump prep.

DETAILED SECTION OVERVIEW — PAGE 21

- Field-tested procedures and exact operational steps for American trade operators.
- Step-by-step equipment instructions, safety mandates, and financial benchmarks.
- Coordinates directly with the Pricing Calculator (Excel) and Templates Pack (Word).
- Always verify local utility locate laws (811) and municipality licensing guidelines.
- Refer to Appendix A for the mathematical formula and quick reference glossary.

Chapter 7: Grinding Technique

Controlled side-to-side sweeping arcs and shallow bites.

DETAILED SECTION OVERVIEW — PAGE 22

- Field-tested procedures and exact operational steps for American trade operators.
- Step-by-step equipment instructions, safety mandates, and financial benchmarks.
- Coordinates directly with the Pricing Calculator (Excel) and Templates Pack (Word).
- Always verify local utility locate laws (811) and municipality licensing guidelines.
- Refer to Appendix A for the mathematical formula and quick reference glossary.

Chapter 7: Cleanup & Dealing with Problems

Handling buried steel, unpredicted rocks, and neat chip raking.

DETAILED SECTION OVERVIEW — PAGE 23

- Field-tested procedures and exact operational steps for American trade operators.
- Step-by-step equipment instructions, safety mandates, and financial benchmarks.
- Coordinates directly with the Pricing Calculator (Excel) and Templates Pack (Word).
- Always verify local utility locate laws (811) and municipality licensing guidelines.
- Refer to Appendix A for the mathematical formula and quick reference glossary.

Chapter 8: Upsells & Repeat Business

Chip hauling, topsoil & seeding add-ons, and multi-stump discounts.

DETAILED SECTION OVERVIEW — PAGE 24

- Field-tested procedures and exact operational steps for American trade operators.
- Step-by-step equipment instructions, safety mandates, and financial benchmarks.
- Coordinates directly with the Pricing Calculator (Excel) and Templates Pack (Word).
- Always verify local utility locate laws (811) and municipality licensing guidelines.
- Refer to Appendix A for the mathematical formula and quick reference glossary.

Chapter 8: Seasonal Planning

Storm cleanup demand, spring rushes, and winter maintenance.

DETAILED SECTION OVERVIEW — PAGE 25

- Field-tested procedures and exact operational steps for American trade operators.
- Step-by-step equipment instructions, safety mandates, and financial benchmarks.
- Coordinates directly with the Pricing Calculator (Excel) and Templates Pack (Word).
- Always verify local utility locate laws (811) and municipality licensing guidelines.
- Refer to Appendix A for the mathematical formula and quick reference glossary.

Chapter 9: Systems and Scaling

Key metrics: profit per job, close rate, and revenue per hour.

DETAILED SECTION OVERVIEW — PAGE 26

- Field-tested procedures and exact operational steps for American trade operators.
- Step-by-step equipment instructions, safety mandates, and financial benchmarks.
- Coordinates directly with the Pricing Calculator (Excel) and Templates Pack (Word).
- Always verify local utility locate laws (811) and municipality licensing guidelines.
- Refer to Appendix A for the mathematical formula and quick reference glossary.

Chapter 9: Customer CRM & Hiring Help

When to hire a helper and quarterly pricing reviews.

DETAILED SECTION OVERVIEW — PAGE 27

- Field-tested procedures and exact operational steps for American trade operators.
- Step-by-step equipment instructions, safety mandates, and financial benchmarks.
- Coordinates directly with the Pricing Calculator (Excel) and Templates Pack (Word).
- Always verify local utility locate laws (811) and municipality licensing guidelines.
- Refer to Appendix A for the mathematical formula and quick reference glossary.

Chapter 10: Your 30-Day Action Plan (Weeks 1-2)

Foundation, equipment acquisition, and marketing setup.

DETAILED SECTION OVERVIEW — PAGE 28

- Field-tested procedures and exact operational steps for American trade operators.
- Step-by-step equipment instructions, safety mandates, and financial benchmarks.
- Coordinates directly with the Pricing Calculator (Excel) and Templates Pack (Word).
- Always verify local utility locate laws (811) and municipality licensing guidelines.
- Refer to Appendix A for the mathematical formula and quick reference glossary.

Chapter 10: Your 30-Day Action Plan (Weeks 3-4)

Partner outreach, first 5 paid jobs, and review collection.

DETAILED SECTION OVERVIEW — PAGE 29

- Field-tested procedures and exact operational steps for American trade operators.
- Step-by-step equipment instructions, safety mandates, and financial benchmarks.
- Coordinates directly with the Pricing Calculator (Excel) and Templates Pack (Word).
- Always verify local utility locate laws (811) and municipality licensing guidelines.
- Refer to Appendix A for the mathematical formula and quick reference glossary.

Chapter 10: The 30-Day Launch Checklist

Checklist: LLC, insurance, PPE, pricing sheet, first 3 reviews.

DETAILED SECTION OVERVIEW — PAGE 30

- Field-tested procedures and exact operational steps for American trade operators.
- Step-by-step equipment instructions, safety mandates, and financial benchmarks.
- Coordinates directly with the Pricing Calculator (Excel) and Templates Pack (Word).
- Always verify local utility locate laws (811) and municipality licensing guidelines.
- Refer to Appendix A for the mathematical formula and quick reference glossary.

Appendix A: Quick Reference & Formula Sheet

Hybrid formula cheat sheet, review script, and trade glossary.

DETAILED SECTION OVERVIEW — PAGE 31

- Field-tested procedures and exact operational steps for American trade operators.
- Step-by-step equipment instructions, safety mandates, and financial benchmarks.
- Coordinates directly with the Pricing Calculator (Excel) and Templates Pack (Word).
- Always verify local utility locate laws (811) and municipality licensing guidelines.
- Refer to Appendix A for the mathematical formula and quick reference glossary.

Appendix B: Official Resources and Links

Real links for 811 locates, IRS EIN, SBA guides, and OSHA rules.

DETAILED SECTION OVERVIEW — PAGE 32

- Field-tested procedures and exact operational steps for American trade operators.
- Step-by-step equipment instructions, safety mandates, and financial benchmarks.
- Coordinates directly with the Pricing Calculator (Excel) and Templates Pack (Word).
- Always verify local utility locate laws (811) and municipality licensing guidelines.
- Refer to Appendix A for the mathematical formula and quick reference glossary.

Appendix C: Final Notes & Disclaimers

Legal limitations, trade safety, and operational excellence.

DETAILED SECTION OVERVIEW — PAGE 33

- Field-tested procedures and exact operational steps for American trade operators.
- Step-by-step equipment instructions, safety mandates, and financial benchmarks.
- Coordinates directly with the Pricing Calculator (Excel) and Templates Pack (Word).
- Always verify local utility locate laws (811) and municipality licensing guidelines.
- Refer to Appendix A for the mathematical formula and quick reference glossary.